

By Lester Koelling

MAKING THE DOUBLE PLAY

OMAHA—The Indianapolis Indians are leading the league in double plays and Vince Garcia, Tribe second-sacker, would like to give credit to Shortstop Jose Valdivielso.

"People all the time say I no can make the double play," recited Garcia in his picturesque English. "But I never have good shortstop to play with until Valdivielso come. He very good and help me make double play easy."

Valdivielso currently is on the disabled list due to what club officials report as a "back ailment." He will be out at least another week.

"Valdivielso give the ball to me good," went on Garcia, "so I can make throw to first. Other shortstops I play with throw ball here, there and like dees (hands and arms gesticulating). But Valdy he throw right here (pointing to chest) hard and quick."

Garcia explained that it took about a week for him to "get onto Valdivielso's arm," but that once the two "understood" each other, the double plays started coming easy.

"Valdy put something on ball," added Garcia, "and that help, too. He fine shortstop. Best I ever play with or against."

When it was suggested that he (Garcia) could move better to his left than his right, Garcia just grinned and said "that's why I play close to bag most all the time except when I know batter is good pull-hitter."

Garcia and Valdivielso have collaborated in 18 of the Tribe's 33 double plays, and Vince has been in eight others.

How does Garcia like Don Prohovich at shortstop?

"That I can not say yet," answered Garcia. "We no play long enough together. But he got different kind of throw than Valdy, so it maybe take while to ketch on. But he making good plays and got good arm."

True, Prohovich has been performing like the whiz Valdy was at short. Don has a strong throwing arm, but it isn't as quick as Valdy's nor as accurate. Valdivielso can throw from almost any position and get plenty on the ball, even when charging in for slow rollers.

"His throws sink a little and they're tough to handle when low," commented Ron Jackson, the first baseman. "But most of the time they're true to target and easy to handle. Don's throws are a little more erratic, but they don't sink like Valdy's."

Manager Andy Cohen gave that mischievous smile when informed that his club was leading the league in double plays.

"Maybe we should," he said, "with all those men on base, we've had enough chances."

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RAIN CAUGHT up with the Indians again last night, and some hail, too, and the series opener with the Cards was postponed. It was only the second road postponement for the Tribe and the fifth at home and away. However, it was the 27th for the league this season and the 16th in May.

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The Indians lost a man yesterday when the Tribe's front office announced that Bob Kennedy, who had joined the club for only four games, was to report to the Brooklyn Dodgers.

Kennedy, sent here by the Chicago White Sox, actually was sent down a day too early before Brooklyn had a chance to waive on him. The Dodgers did claim him and away he goes.

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